

33.4 ANOTHER WAY TO SAY "I WISH"

PRESENT REGRETS

Stronger regrets about the present can be expressed by using "if only" and the past simple.



These mountains are incredible!
If only I knew how to ski.

PAST REGRETS

Stronger regrets about the past can be expressed by using "if only" and the past perfect.



I really wanted to take pictures.
If only I'd charged the battery.

FURTHER EXAMPLES

I love the sound of the guitar.
If only I played it better.

I'm sure the teacher explained this. **If only I remembered** it!

The show is completely sold out!
If only I'd arrived sooner.

I couldn't finish the marathon.
If only I had trained harder.

33.5 PAST REGRETS

"Should have" or "ought to have" are used to express regret that something did or didn't happen in the past.

This bill is so big. I { **should have**
ought to have } **used** less electricity.

Past participle.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

Maybe I **should have** used energy-saving light bulbs.



The negative form "ought not to have" is rarely used in UK English and never used in US English.
I **shouldn't have** fallen asleep with the TV on.

